**ICASSSD**
International Center for Applied Systems Science for Sustainable Development

# ONLINE RESEARCH SCHOOL ON DYNAMIC SUSTAINABLE SOLUTIONS

## MAY - SEPTEMBER 2026

**In Collaboration with Dayalbagh Educational Institute, Dayalbagh, Agra-282005, UP, India**

# Introduction

**REVERED PROF. P.S. SATSANGI**
**Chairman Advisory Committee on Education, Dayalbagh Educational Institutions, Agra, India**

Glimpses of past Inaugurals

**MR. GUR SAROOP SOOD**
**President, Ra Dha Sva Aa Mi Satsang Sabha, Dayalbagh & Dayalbagh Educational Institute, Agra, India**

**PROF. C PATVARDHAN**
**Director/Vice Chancellor, Dayalbagh Educational Institute, Agra, India**

Sustainable development sits at the intersection of ecology, economics, engineering, governance, and society. No single discipline can capture its full complexity, nor solve its most pressing challenges. International Centre for Applied Systems Science and Sustainable Development (ICASSSD) is pleased to announce its fourth edition of its research school on **'Dynamic Sustainable Solutions'**. The school brings participants into direct conversation with leading researchers, practitioners, and innovators at the forefront of sustainability science and global policy. Each session centres on a distinguished speaker presenting their own work followed by open discussion and debate. In addition, participants will work in multi-disciplinary teams on original research projects across the programme, culminating in papers submitted for publication in a compendium and, where appropriate, to peer-reviewed journals.

The school runs bi-weekly from May through September 2026, online, on weekend mornings (10:00 AM – 12:00 noon EST).

Participation is entirely free of charge.

# PAST SPEAKERS IN RESEARCH SCHOOL

**PROF. KEITH HEIPEL**
Professor, University of Waterloo

**PROF. SACHIN CHATURVEDI**
Vice Chancellor, Nalanda University

**PROF. S. MAHENDRA DEV**
Chairman, Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM).

**PROF. JENNIFER BOGER**
Adjunct Assistant Professor, University of Waterloo

**PROF. PAMI DUA**
Member, Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM) & Former Director, Delhi School of Economics

**PROF. JONATHAN AIKMAN**
Lawyer & Adjunct Faculty member, Queen's University, Cornell University and York University

**PROF. SARUP RANI MATHUR**
Dean's Fellow & Professor, Arizona State University

## Objectives

1. Equip participants with the skills to design, conduct, and write up research in sustainability science.

2. Expose participants to frontier research across the full spectrum of sustainability science

3. Stimulate multi-disciplinary dialogue and critical thinking on complex sustainability challenges.

## Format: Online

1. Each session pairs one hour of distinguished lecture with one hour of hands-on research. Participants will work in small, multi-disciplinary teams on original research projects of their choosing, guided week by week by an ICASSSD mentor.

2. The programme closes with completed papers submitted for publication in a compendium and, where appropriate, to peer-reviewed journals.

**Bi-weekly sessions on weekends, 10 AM – 12 noon EST. Online.**

# Schedule

| | 10AM-11AM | 11AM-12NOON |
|---|---|---|
| | **Distinguished Lecture** | **Discussion / Research Session** |
| May 30, 2026 | **Opening Keynote and Panel: Dynamic Sustainable Solutions for the Next Century** | Welcome and Orientation |
| June 6, 2026 | Thematic Lecture 1 | Identifying Research Themes & Forming Teams |
| June 13, 2026 | Research Design Workshop: Problem Statement, Research Questions, Objectives, and Methods | Team-Based Proposal Development |
| June 20, 2026 | Thematic Lecture 2 | Proposal Clinic with Mentor Feedback |
| June 27, 2026 | Research Methods and Sources Workshop | Developing Research Frameworks and Work Plans |
| July 4, 2026 | Thematic Lecture 3 | Guided Group Work on Research Projects |
| July 11, 2026 | Stage 1 Progress Presentations: Research Question, Framework, and Method | Feedback and Discussion |
| July 18, 2026 | Thematic Lecture 4 | Group Work on Analysis and Paper Sections |
| July 25, 2026 | Academic Writing Workshop: Structure, Argument, Evidence, and Referencing | Drafting Key Sections of the Paper |
| Aug 8, 2026 | Thematic Lecture 5 | Developing Results, Discussion, & Conclusion |
| Aug 15, 2026 | Stage 2 Progress Presentations: Draft Findings and Paper Structure | Draft Paper Review and Peer Feedback |
| Aug 22, 2026 | Revision and Paper Refinement Workshop | Revising Drafts and Strengthening Arguments |
| Aug 29 - Sep 12, 2026 | Independent Team Work and Mentor Consultations | Refining and Finalising Papers |
| Sep 19, 2026 | **Closing Symposium: Participant Research Presentations** | Certificates and Closing Remarks |

# Thematic Focus Areas

**Focus of the 2026 School**

- Agroecology and sustainable food systems
- Green engineering and net-zero technology pathways
- Greenhouse gas emissions and climate science
- Circular economy and corporate sustainability
- Socioeconomic dimensions of sustainable development: poverty, gender, and climate justice
- Systems thinking and complexity in sustainability transitions
- Sustainability ethics, governance, and policy
- AI for Social Good
- AI for Healthcare and Data-driven Biotechnology

# Who should attend?

**The Research School on Dynamic Sustainable Solutions is designed for:**

- Early-career researchers, graduate students, and advanced undergraduates in applied sciences, environment, economics, management, sustainability, and technology.
- Researchers and practitioners interested in multi-disciplinary approaches to complex sustainability challenges.

## How to Apply

Application & Key Dates

- **Registration Deadline: May 10, 2026**
- Programme Opens: **May 30, 2026**
- Programme Closes: **September 19, 2026**
- Registration Fee: **Free of charge**

## Benefits of Participation

- Certificate of Participation issued to all attendees upon completion of the programme.
- Direct access to distinguished international researchers and their current work.
- Opportunity to connect with a multi-disciplinary global community of sustainability researchers and practitioners.
- Reference Letter and Volunteer Hours.
- Priority consideration for future research collaboration and summer positions with ICASSSD.
- Exposure to diverse methodological and disciplinary perspectives on sustainability challenges.

SCAN ME

**To Apply - https://forms.gle/5DFheFSy4MVdD6g26**

**PROF. APURVA NARAYAN**
University of Western Ontario, Canada

**DR. ASHITA ALLAMRAJU**
University of Toronto, Canada

**PROF. BHAGWAN DAS**
Dayalbagh Educational Institute, Dayalbagh, Agra, UP, India

**For more information, please contact: research.school@icasssd.org**

# Testimonials

At ICASSSD, I gained valuable knowledge and had the opportunity to collaborate with students and professors worldwide. Despite my initial nervousness about research, the supportive environment helped me develop skills in data collection, literature reviews, and interdisciplinary collaboration. The research school's multidisciplinary approach allowed me to work with experts beyond my field, making the experience truly enriching. I'm grateful for the opportunity to learn and connect with such an inspiring community!

**-Dailin Huang, McGill University**

The ICASSSD Research School helped me turn a rough idea into a published AAAI symposium paper. Working in a multidisciplinary team, I learned how to ask better research questions, analyze real-world health data, and co-author a study. I finished the program with a paper, new skills, and meaningful opportunities and connections.

**-Earlel Thiyagaratnam, Faculty of Information & Media Studies, University of Western Ontario, London, ON**

The Research School gave me a great introduction to the research process! It was a wonderful environment to learn this process because it allowed me to investigate a topic of strong personal interest, that being sustainable dietary practices around the world.

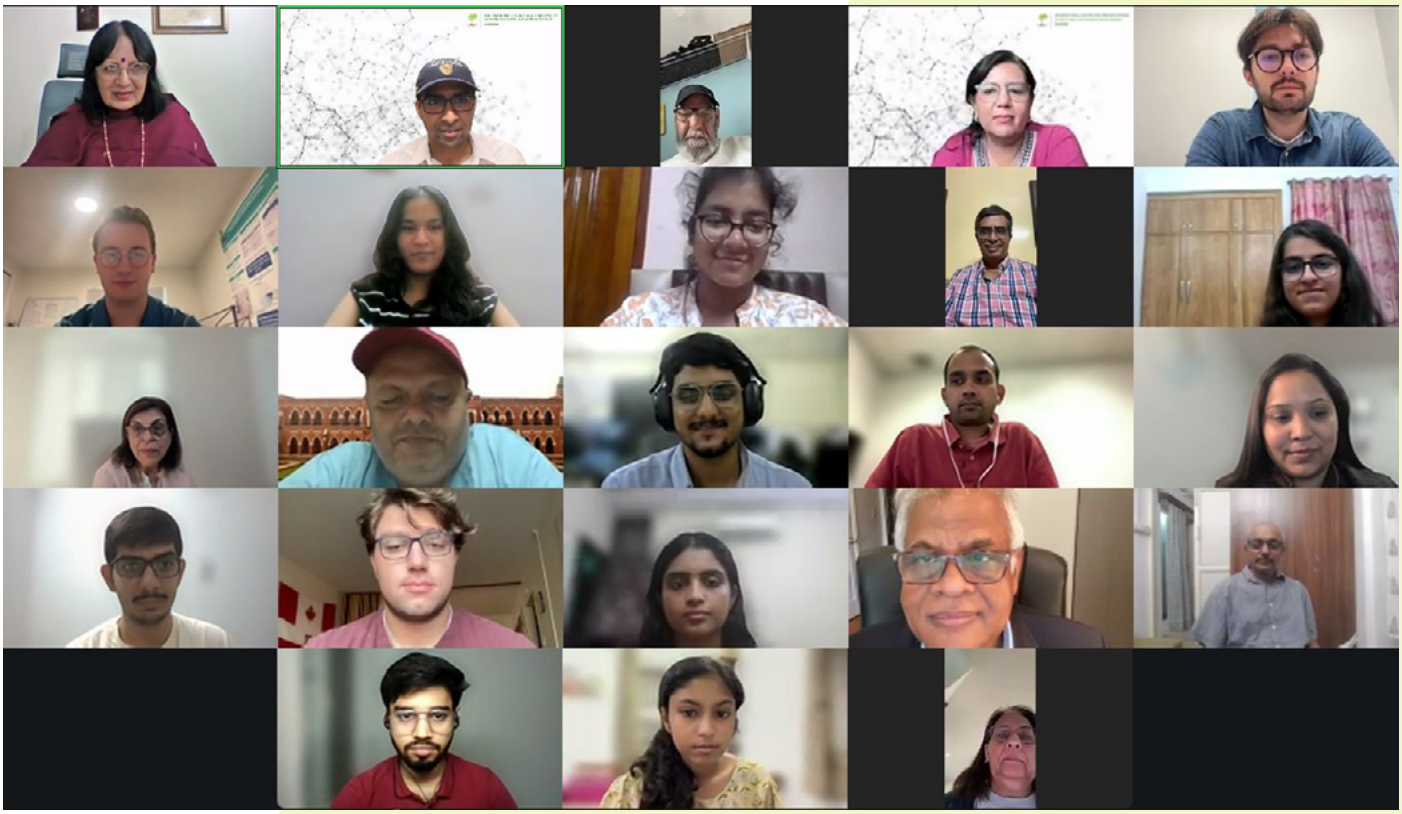
**-Luke Rossi, Brown University**

**ICASSSD**

**International Center for Applied Systems Science for Sustainable Development**

**About ICASSSD**

The International Centre for Applied Systems Science and Sustainable Development (ICASSSD) is a not-for-profit international research organisation headquartered in Cambridge, Canada. ICASSSD conducts and facilitates research across the multi-disciplinary domains of sustainability and applied systems science, with a commitment to generating practical impacts in communities worldwide. The Centre actively supports co-operative education, entrepreneurial learning, and curiosity-driven inquiry.



Valedictory function, 2025

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